SUMMER PRESS REVIEW

What happened (or not!) in the English-speaking world over the summer?

A) READ and find out by matching each picture with the corresponding paragraph – complete with the words from the box.
















1776 / 2010 / 17 / 74 / 3rd / airstrikes / smartphone / civilians / economic / Argentina / New York City / London / Hormuz / Italy / United Kingdom / extra / celestial / traditional / darkness / signing / eclipse / privacy / Semiquincentennial / return / temperatures / sun / evacuate / resigned / heatwaves / gathered / suitcases / conflict / smoke / Prince / Charles / King / Games / alternative / replacing / breathtaking

1) July 1, 2026: The Trump administration announced a new peace plan called the "Board of Peace," which proposed creating special "Hamas-Free Humanitarian Zones" to protect _____ in Gaza.

2) July 3 : pop music icon Taylor Swift and American football star Travis Kelce were married. The private ceremony took place at the famous Madison Square Garden in _____with around 1,000 guests in attendance.

3) July 4 : The United States celebrated its _____ (250th anniversary), marking exactly 250 years since the _____ of the Declaration of Independence in _____.

4) July 20 : Andy Burnham became the Prime Minister of the United Kingdom, _____ Keir Starmer. He automatically became the new Prime Minister after meeting with _____ Charles III. Keir Starmer _____ as Prime Minister in June 2026 due to political pressure, low popularity, and a lack of _____ growth.

5) Mid-to-Late July : Heavy summer _____ triggered massive wildfires across parts of Europe and Canada, sending thick _____ across North America and threatening local infrastructure. Many people had to _____ their homes. Coastal waters experienced their highest recorded ocean surface _____ for July.

6) July 27–30 : The ongoing military _____ between the U.S. and Iran saw temporary pauses in bombing, followed by heavy retaliatory U.S. _____ on Revolutionary Guard targets and new economic sanctions, amid rising blockades near the Red Sea and Strait of _____.

7) July 31 : A leading tech company revealed its next _____ model will completely remove the front-facing "selfie" camera to address growing user anxiety over digital _____ and unauthorized face-scanning.

8) -The 2026 Commonwealth _____ took place from **July 23 to August 2, 2026**, in Glasgow, Scotland. This edition was much smaller than usual. It featured only 10 sports compared to _____ sports in past years. More than 3,000 athletes from _____ different nations and territories traveled to Scotland to compete. Australia won the most medals, finishing at the top of the table with 171 medals (70 gold). England finished second, and Canada finished _____.

9) July 19 : Spain defeated _____ 1–0 in _____ time to win the 2026 FIFA World Cup final.This is Spain's second men's World Cup title in their history, exactly 16 years after their first win in _____.

10) August 1 : The local government of Venice, _____, passed a law banning tourists from using traditional hard-shelled wheeled _____, forcing visitors to carry fabric bags or backpacks instead.

11) August 5: McDonald's announced it will permanently remove _____ white potato French fries from its global menu by the end of the year, replacing them entirely with a healthier sweet potato _____.

12) August 12 : Millions of spectators _____ across Europe to witness a _____ total solar eclipse, an extraordinary _____ event where the moon fully obscured the _____, plunging parts of Iceland and Spain into daytime _____ while the United Kingdom experienced a dramatic partial _____.

13) August 21 : Reports emerged that _____ Harry and Meghan Markle were planning a gradual _____ to live in the _____. The couple allegedly plans to reside in a private, non-royal home outside _____ to be closer to King _____ III.

B - Vocabulary: Find the English equivalents of the following words (mostly adjectives) in the stories, they are in the right order. Give their French translation.

1. exclusive =
2. moderate =
3. enormous =
4. dense =
5. severe =
6. increasing =
7. prominent =
8. expanding =
9. more wholesome =
10. stunning =
11. completely =
12. striking =

C-There are three pieces of fake news in the list on the first page. Discuss with a neighbour, using the expressions below, to identify which ones are untrue.

Useful starters	**To express doubt or disbelief**
➢ ***Story n°… may be true because…*** ➢ ***n°… seems believable as…*** ➢ ***It could have happened since…***	➢ ***I doubt paragraph 5 … because…*** ➢ ***It doesn't sound realistic that…*** ➢ ***It is unlikely that…*** ➢ ***It can't have happened because…***
To give reasons	**To agree or disagree**
➢ ***…because I have never heard of…*** ➢ ***… because if this were true, people would +bv*** ➢ ***…because it would be too expensive / dangerous / unusual***	➢ ***I agree/disagree (=don't agree) with you because…*** ➢ ***I see your point, but…***

D – 1) **Classify these words**, from the pieces of news, according to their pronunciation of <ou>: ***announced, around, tourist, couple, outside***. Here are some more common words to classify: southern, country, outrage, should, enough, bound.

/ aʊ/ as in house	/ ʌ/ as in touch	/ʊ/ as in could

D-2) **If you're a quick worker and finish before the end, match each word (often found in the news) with its phonetic transcription and write the translation**

Labour= - - /æmbɪʃəs/

attempt = - - /ɪʃuːz/

wounded= - - /wɪðdrɔːəl/

rifle= - - /leɪbə/

diagnosis= - - /gʌvənd/

privacy= - - /wuːndɪd/

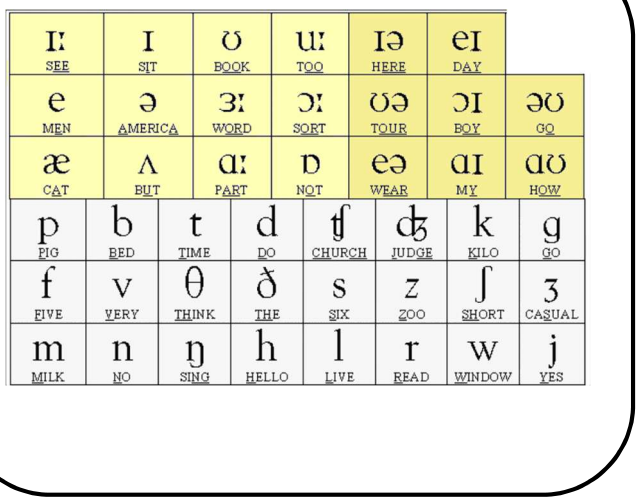
disastrous= - - /ətempt/

withdrawal= - - /raɪfəl/

governed= - - /daɪəgnəʊsɪs/

issues= - - /dɪzɑːstrəs/

ambitious= - - /prɪvəsi/



Then identify the primary stress in each of the words above and mark it with an apostrophe in the phonetic transcription